

USING PARTICIPATORY ACTION TO DEVELOP AND REFINE AN ONLINE MOTOR COMPETENCE ASSESSMENT RESOURCE FOR TEACHERS

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INTRODUCTION

Motor competence is known as goal-directed human movement and is important for children's health and participation in physical activity¹. Primary physical education is an ideal setting for its development, and accurate assessment helps teachers identify students' needs and target instruction^{2,3}. However, evidence-based assessments are seldom used because teachers face limited time, education, awareness, access and support^{4,5}. This study used participatory action with teachers and education representatives to develop and refine the Movement Assessment in Practice (MAP) platform, an online resource designed to make evidence-based motor competence assessment practical in primary physical education.

METHODS

A five-phase process guided MAP's development: (1) a prototype was created with education representatives to address previously identified barriers; (2) 44 primary physical education teachers provided feedback during a workshop; (3) three teachers completed user journey and experience interviews; (4) the resource was iteratively refined in response to participant feedback; and (5) the final MAP resource was launched on the Victorian Curriculum and Assessment Authority website. Workshop data and interview transcripts were analysed thematically to identify implementation barriers, valued features and priorities for refinement.

RESULTS AND DISCUSSION

Feedback from representatives, workshops, and interviews shaped both the content and functionality of the MAP. Teachers and representatives agreed the platform addressed key barriers such as limited knowledge, time, and access, offering an evidence-informed, technology-based solution. User journey interviews highlighted the MAP's user-friendly interface and capacity to support teachers in understanding and applying MC assessments. Participants valued the inclusion of valid and feasible tools, step-by-step guides, instructional videos, and automated downloadable scorecards. Requests were made for additional assessment options and enhanced time-saving features. Most teachers viewed the MAP as feasible, acceptable, and likely to be adopted, although some suggested improvements (e.g. a mobile app version) could not be implemented due to resource constraints.

CONCLUSIONS

Involving teachers and education representatives throughout development produced a contextually relevant resource that responded directly to barriers encountered in schools^{4,5}. The MAP platform connects evidence-based assessments with practical instructions, professional learning and time-saving tools in a trusted curriculum platform. The findings demonstrate how participatory action can help translate research into a usable educational resource⁶. Evaluation of MAP's reach and implementation is now needed to determine whether this promising resource changes assessment practice and supports more targeted teaching of children's movement skills.

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